

Raw Materials of Traditional Bodo Handloom

Introduction

Raw materials are one of the most important components of the traditional Bodo handloom industry. Since ancient times, the Bodo community has used a variety of natural fibers for weaving different types of textiles and traditional garments.

Major Raw Materials

The major raw materials used in traditional Bodo weaving are:

- Muga silk
- Tusser silk
- Eri silk
- Pat silk
- Cotton yarn

These materials are used to produce various handwoven products such as Dokhona, Aronai, Gamosa, shawls, and other traditional textiles.

Muga Silk

Muga silk is a golden-colored natural silk that is highly valued for its durability and shine. It is traditionally used in the production of special garments and ceremonial textiles.

Eri Silk

Eri silk, locally associated with **Endi Emphou** (Eri worm), is one of the most commonly used silks in Bodo weaving. It is soft, warm, and suitable for making shawls and traditional clothing.

Tusser Silk

Tusser silk is a natural silk known for its rich texture and strength. It is used for weaving decorative and traditional fabrics.

Pat Silk

Pat silk is a fine and smooth silk fiber that is used to produce high-quality textiles and traditional garments.

Cotton Yarn

Cotton yarn has been an essential raw material in Bodo weaving for centuries. Traditionally, Bodo women cultivated cotton, spun yarn, and prepared threads for weaving various textile products.

Traditional Silkworm Rearing

Bodo women have traditionally been skilled in rearing silkworms, especially:

- **Muga Emphow (Muga worm)**
- **Endi Emphou (Eri worm)**

The cocoons produced by these silkworms are processed to extract silk threads, which are then used for weaving different types of cloth and textile materials.

Importance of Raw Materials

The use of natural raw materials such as silk and cotton has played a vital role in preserving the cultural identity and traditional weaving practices of the Bodo community. These materials contribute to the beauty, durability, and uniqueness of Bodo handloom products.